

Herbs that Regulate Qi

- Herbs that regulate qi function to promote normal circulation of qi, correct reversed flow of qi, and eliminate qi stagnation.
- Most of the herbs that regulate qi are aromatic and warm, with acrid and bitter properties.
- The most important organs involved in the qi mechanism are the Lungs, which govern qi; the Liver, which governs dredging and draining; the Spleen, which governs transformation and transportation; and the Stomach, which governs receiving and taking in.
- These herbs are rarely used alone; instead, they are often combined with others based on the specific nature of the disorder.
- The herbs that regulate qi are drying in nature and should be used with caution for patients with qi and yin deficiency or yin deficiency caused by febrile disorders.

Name	Similarities	Differences
Chen Pi (<i>Pericarpium Citri Reticulatae</i>)	Regulate qi, transform/dissolve phlegm	Regulates Spleen and Stomach qi, dries dampness, and transforms phlegm
Qing Pi (<i>Pericarpium Citri Reticulatae Viride</i>)		Regulates Liver qi, breaks up qi stagnation and disperses nodules, and reduces stagnation.
Zhi Shi (<i>Fructus Aurantii Immaturus</i>)		Breaks up qi stagnation and accumulation, dissolves phlegm, and expels focal distension
Zhi Ke (<i>Fructus Aurantii</i>)		Regulates qi and spreads the middle jiao (for weak or deficient constitution)
Fo Shou (<i>Fructus Citri Sarcodactylis</i>)		Relieves Liver qi stagnation (mild) and dried dampness, relieves cough with profuse phlegm.
Da Fu Pi (<i>Pericarpium Arecae</i>)		Directs qi downward and expands the Middle Jiao, promotes urination, and relieves edema.
Mu Xiang (<i>Radix Aucklandiae</i>)	Regulate qi, relieve pain	Regulates Spleen, Stomach, and Large Intestine qi
Xiang Fu (<i>Rhizoma Cyperi</i>)		Smooth the Liver, regulates menstruation; used mainly for obstetric/gynecologic disorders.
Wu Yao (<i>Radix Linderae</i>)		Warms the Kidney, disperses cold, used for lower abdominal pain and frequent urination.
Xie Bai (<i>Bulbus Allii Macrostemonis</i>)		Opens Yang Qi and disperses stagnation due to cold phlegm, treats xiong

Tan Xiang (<i>Lignum Santali Albi</i>)	Disperses cold, alleviates chest pain caused by cold.
Chen Xiang (<i>Lignum Aquilariae Resinatum</i>)	Redirects rebellious qi downward, warms, and aids the Kidney in grasping the qi.
Chuan Lian Zi (<i>Fructus Toosendan</i>)	Cold in nature, regulates Liver qi, more for pain from heat, kills parasites.
Mei Gui Hua (<i>Rosea rugosae Flos</i>)	Smooths the liver, relieves constraint, harmonizes the blood, and disperses stasis

Chén Pí 陈皮

“aged peel”

- *Pericarpium Citri Reticulatae*
- **English:** tangerine peel, citrus peel
- **Properties:** acrid, bitter, warm, aromatic
- **Channels:** Lung, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Regulates qi, improves the transporting function of the Spleen, adjusts the middle, and relieves the diaphragm:

Indications – for SP or ST qi stagnation manifesting in nausea, vomiting, abdominal fullness, and belching.

- Abdominal fullness or pain: + *Zhi Ke, Mu Xiang*
- Nausea and vomiting due to rising stomach qi: + *Sheng Jiang, Zhu Ru* (Formula: *Ju pi tang*)
- Abdominal pain with diarrhea caused by Liver overacting on the Spleen: + *Bai Zhu, Bai Shao, Fang Feng* (*tong xie yao fang*)
- Poor digestion due to Sp and St deficiency: + *Dang Shen, Bai Zhu, Zhi Gan Cao* (Formula: *Yi gong san*)

Actions: Regulates qi, dries dampness and transforms phlegm:

Indications – important herb for phlegm-damp cough w/ a stifling sensation in the chest and/or diaphragm and copious, viscous sputum

- Chest congestion, abdominal fullness, fatigue, decreased appetite, loose stools, and thick, greasy tongue coat: + *Cang Zhu, Hou Po*
- Cough or wheezing with copious phlegm, stifling sensation in the chest due to qi and phlegm obstructing the Lung, leading to failure of the Lung qi to descend: + *Ban Xia, Fu Ling* (Formula: *Er chen tang*)

Main Actions:

- Regulates qi and adjusts middle jiao

- Dries dampness and transforms phlegm
- Dosage: 3-10 grams in decoction.

Cautions:

- Acrid, bitter, warm, and drying, Chen Pi should be used with caution in patients with fluid deficiency, excess heat in the interior, and/or cough caused by qi or yin deficiency.
- It should be used with extreme caution in hematemesis.

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Chen Pi
- What are the properties of Chen Pi?
- What channels does Chen Pi enter?
- Herbs for treating abdominal fullness.
- Herbs for treating damp-phlegm obstructing the Lung
- What are the pharmaceutical mechanisms of Chen Pi in treating GI and Lung conditions?

Ju Ye 橘叶
Folium Citri Rubrum

- It is orange tree leaves.
- It is orange tree leaves. It is acrid, bitter, and neutral. It regulates Liver qi, reduces swelling, and disperses stagnation.
- Clinical applications include hypochondriac pain, breast abscesses, palpable masses, and/or tumors. The recommended dosage of Ju Ye is 6 to 10 grams.

Hua Ju Hong 化橘红
Exocarpium Citri Grandis

- It is the dried outermost rind of pummelo. It is bitter, warm, acrid, and enters the Lung, Spleen, and Stomach. It regulates qi, opens the middle jiao, dries dampness, dissolves phlegm, and relieves food stagnation. It is used for cough with profuse sputum with no heat signs. The recommended dosage of Hua Ju Hong is 3 to 10 grams. Hua Ju Hong should be used with caution in patients with qi and yin deficiencies. Hua Ju Hong is also known as Hua Ju Pi.

Ju He 橘核
Semen Citri Rubrum

- Ju He is orange seed. It is bitter and neutral. It disperses nodules, activates qi circulation, and relieves pain.
- It is often used to treat Liver qi stagnation with phlegm obstruction, such as hernia, pain, and swelling of the testes, mastitis, and nodules of the breast. Ju He may be used internally as a decoction or powder, or topically as a cream or

ointment. Frying it with salt directs its functions to the Kidney and enhances its effect in treating hernia, testicular swelling, and pain. The dosage of Ju He is 3 to 10 grams.

Qing Pi 青皮

“blue-green peel” “green peel”

- *Pericarpium Citri Reticulatae Viride*
- **English:** immature or green tangerine peel
- **Properties:** bitter, acrid, warm
- **Channels:** Gallbladder, Liver, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Spreads Liver qi and breaks up stagnant qi:

Indications – for constrained LV qi patterns with such symptoms as distention and pain in the chest, breast or hypochondriac regions or hernial pain.

- Hypochondriac pain due to Liver qi stagnation: *Chai Hu, Yu Jin*
- Breast distention and pain or breast nodules: *Chai Hu, Xiang Fu, Xia Ku Cao*
- Breast abscess : *Jin Yin Hua, Pu Gong Ying*
- Cold-type hernial pain or abdominal pain: *Wu Yao, Xiao Hui Xiang*

Actions: Dissipates clumps and reduces stagnation

Indications – for food stagnation with accumulation which manifests as pain, distention or a stifling sensation in the epigastrium: *Shan Zha, Mai Ya, Shen Qu*

Actions: Disperses nodules and breaks up stasis

Indications – for mass formation or malarial disorders due to qi and blood stagnation: *Shan Leng, E Zhu, Yu Jin*

Main Actions:

- Spreads Liver Qi, breaks up qi stagnation
- Disperses nodules, reduces stagnation

Dosage: 3-10 grams in decoction.

Cautions:

Use Qing Pi with caution for patients with qi deficiency, as the strong dispersing quality may consume qi.

Long-term use or large doses of Qing Pi are not recommended.

Review questions

- Properties and channels entered
- Actions and indications

- Compare *Chen Pi* and *Qing Pi*
- Cautions

Zhǐ Shí 枳实

- *Fructus Immaturus Citri Aurantii*
- **English:** immature fruit of the bitter orange
- **Properties:** bitter, acrid, slightly cold
- **Channels:** Large Intestine, Spleen, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Breaks up stagnant qi and reduces accumulation:

Indications – for gastrointestinal disorders due to stagnant qi in the middle jiao, causing indigestion, abdominal fullness, distention, and belching.

- Focal distention, foul-smelling belching due to food stagnation: *Shan Zha, Mai Ya, Shen Qu*
- Abdominal pain, distention, and constipation due to heat clumping with the stool: *Da Huang, Hou Po, (Formula: Xiao cheng qi tang)*
- Abdominal distention and bloating due to Spleen deficiency: *Bai Zhu (zhi zhu wan)*
- Dysenteric diarrhea with tenesmus due to accumulation and stagnation of damp-heat: *Da Huang, Huang Lian, Huang Qin (Formula: zhi shi dao zhi wan)*

Actions: Dissolves phlegm and expels focal distention:

Indications – for focal distention and fullness in the chest and epigastrium due to phlegm obstructing the qi mechanism

- Xiong Bi (painful obstruction of the chest) caused by Heart yang deficiency and accumulation of cold phlegm: *Xie Bai, Gui Zhi, Gua Lou*
- Epigastric fullness and distention, lack of appetite, and fatigue: *Hou Po, Ban Xia, Bai Zhu*

Actions: Zhi Shi is also used with qi tonifying herbs for gastriectasis 胃扩张, gastroptosis 胃下垂, rectal prolapse, and uterine prolapse.

Recently used to raise blood pressure.

Main Actions:

- Breaks up stagnant qi and reduces accumulation
- Dissolves phlegm and expels focal distention

Dosage: 3-10 grams. The maximum dosage of *Zhi Shi* is 15 grams.

Caution:

Use *Zhi Shi* with caution during pregnancy.

It should not be used as a single remedy for patients with Spleen and Stomach deficiency since its qi-regulating potency may disperse and consume qi. Patients with Spleen and Stomach deficiency should be treated with both qi tonics and qi-regulating herbs.

Zhi Shi should be used with caution in patients with gastric, duodenal, or peptic ulcers because of the acidity of the herb.

Zhǐ Ké 枳壳

- *Fructus Citri Aurantii*
- **English:** aurantium fruit, bitter orange
- **Properties:** acrid, bitter, cool
- **Channels:** Spleen, Stomach, Large Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Relieves distention

Indications: The qi-regulating function of *Zhe Ke* is mild and is most helpful for patients who are weak or deficient.

Actions: Breaks up stagnant qi and resolves accumulation

Indications: *Zhi Ke* is mild in action. It breaks up stagnant qi in mild-to-moderate cases of stagnation and accumulation and expands the chest to relieve congestion.

Review questions

- Actions and indications
- Compare Qing Pi, Zhi Shi and Zhi Shi and Zhi Ke
- Compare What are the strongest herbs to break up stagnant qi?
- Herbs for Yang Ming Fu, food stagnation or dysenteric diarrhea.
- Herb for Xiong Bi (chest pain)
- What are the cautions with Zhi Shi?
- What herbs are used for prolapse?

Fó Shǒu 佛手 "Buddha's hand"

- *Fructus Citri Sarcodactylis*
- **English:** finger citron fruit
- **Properties:** acrid, bitter, slightly warm
- **Channels:** Liver, Lung, Stomach, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Spreads and regulates Liver qi and harmonizes the middle jiao:

Indications – for rib or flank pain, distention, and belching or hiccups due to constrained Liver qi or Liver overacting on the Spleen.

- *Fo Shou* is acrid yet not drying in action. It is an excellent herb for promoting the circulation of qi and relieving Liver qi stagnation.
- It effectively activates and regulates qi circulation without drying or consuming yin. However, it only has a mild function to relieve pain.

Actions: Dries dampness, transforms phlegm, and relieves cough

Indications - for chronic and persistent cough with profuse sputum and chest and flank pain. It mildly dries dampness and transforms phlegm.

Main Actions:

- Spreads and regulates Liver qi (mild) and harmonizes the middle jiao
- Dries dampness, transforms phlegm, and relieves cough

Dosage: 3-10 grams.

Review questions

- Actions and indications
- Compare Chen Pi and Fo Shou

Mù Xiāng 木香

“fragrant wood” “wood aroma”

- *Radix Aucklandiae Lappae*
- **English:** costus root, saussurea, aucklandia
- **Properties:** acrid, bitter, warm
- **Channels:** Gallbladder, Large Intestine, Spleen, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Promotes the movement of qi, regulates the middle jiao, and alleviates pain.

Indications – for SP or ST stagnant qi with such symptoms as lack of appetite, epigastric or abdominal pain or distention, nausea or vomiting.

- Epigastric and abdominal fullness and pain: *Zhi Ke, Chuan Lian Zi, Yan Hu Suo*; *Mu Xiang* is a common herb for this condition.
- Damp-heat diarrhea: *Huang Lian, Mu Xiang (xiang lian wan)*
- Food stagnation, qi stagnation, diarrhea and rectal tenesmus due to damp-heat: *Bing Lang, Zhi Ke, Huang Lian, Mu Xiang*

Actions: Strengthens the Spleen and prevents stagnation:

Indications – used with tonifying herbs to ameliorate their side effects; especially useful when the T+T functions of the Spleen are weak

Indications - The chief manifestations of Spleen qi deficiency include epigastric and abdominal fullness, distention, bloating, pain, poor appetite, vomiting, diarrhea, preference for warmth, and pressure applied to the abdomen, and white, greasy tongue coating: *Dang Shen, Bai Zhu, Sha Ren (xiang sha liu jun zi tang)*

Indications- Distention and pain in the hypochondriac region, bitter taste in the mouth, yellow tongue coating and possibly jaundice due to Spleen interfering with the normal transformation and transportation function, damp-heat begins to accumulate, leading to disharmony between the Liver and Spleen: *Chai Hu, Yu Jin, Zhi Ke, Da Huang, Yin Chen, Jin Qian Cao*

Main Actions:

- Moves the qi
- Regulates the middle jiao (Liver and Spleen)
- Alleviates pain.

Dosage: 3-10 grams. Unprepared *Mu Xiang* is better for treating qi stagnation. The roasted herb more effectively treats diarrhea and rectal tenesmus.

Cautions

Acrid, warm and drying. *Mu Xiang* should be used with caution for patients with yin deficiency, fluid deficiency or excess fire.

Review questions

- Actions, indications and properties.
- Which major organ does *Mu Xiang* focus on?
- What is the difference between *Sheng Mu Xiang* and roasted *Mu Xiang*?
- Cautions when using *Mu Xiang*

Xiāng Fù 香附

“aromatic appendage”

- *Rhizoma Cyperi Rotundi*
- **English:** nut-grass rhizome, cyperus
- **Properties:** acrid, slightly bitter, slightly sweet, neutral
- **Channels:** Liver

Actions and Indications

Actions: Spreads and regulates Liver qi:

Indications – for constrained Liver qi patterns with hypochondriac pain and epigastric distention, as well as disharmony between the LV and SP

- Hypochondriac pain due liver qi constrain: *Chai Hu, Qing Pi, Bai Shao*
- Liver and Stomach disharmony: *Mu Xiang, Fo Shou*
- Epigastric and abdominal pain caused by cold: *Gao Liang Jiang (Formula: liang fu wan)*
- Hernial pain: *Xiao Hui Xiang, Wu Zhu Yu, Wu Yao*

Actions: Regulates menstruation and alleviates pain:

Indications – used to facilitate the flow of LV qi in gynecological disorders with such signs as dysmenorrhea or irregular menstruation, abdominal pain and breast distention.

- Irregular menstruation with breast distention and abdominal pain: *Dang Gui, Chuan Xiong, Bai Shao, Chai Hu*
- Breast distention or breast nodules: *Chai Hu, Dang Gui, Gua Lou, Qing Pi*

Main Actions:

- Smooth and regulates Liver qi
- Regulates menses and alleviates pain

Dosage: 6-12 grams.

Review questions

- Properties and main organ enters
- Actions and indications
- “yao yao” for gynecological disorder

Wū Yào 乌药
“black medicine”

- *Radix Linderae Strychnifoliae*
- **English:** lindera root
- **Properties:** acrid, warm
- **Channels:** Bladder, Kidney, Lung, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Acrid warm to promote the flow of the qi, disperses cold, and alleviates pain.

Indications – for a stifling sensation in the chest, hypochondriac pain, and epigastric and abdominal pain and distention due to cold constraint and qi stagnation.

- Hypochondriac pain with feelings of oppression in the chest: *Xie Bai, Gua Lou Pi, Yu Jin, Yan Hu Suo*
- Epigastric and abdominal fullness and pain: *Mu Xiang, Zhi Ke, Wu Zhu Yu*

- Hernial pain, lower abdominal pain, and testicular pain caused by cold: *Xiao Hui Xiang, Mu Xiang, Qing Pi*
- Menstrual pain: *Xiang Fu, Dang Gui*

Actions: Warms the Kidneys and disperses cold

Indications – for frequent urination or urinary incontinence due to insufficiency of KD yang and cold from deficiency of the Bladder: *Yi Zhi Ren, Shan Yao*

Main Actions:

- Moves qi, disperses cold, and relieves pain
- Warms the Kidney and disperses cold

Dosage: 3-10 grams

Review questions

- Properties and channel entering of Wu Yao
- Actions and indications of Wu Yao
- Wu Yao combines with many other herbs for treating various pain due to qi stagnation and cold constraint.

Chén Xiāng 沉香

“sinking aroma” “sinking fragrance”

- *Lignum Aquilariae Resinatum*
- **English:** Chinese eaglewood, aquilaria
- **Properties:** acrid, aromatic, bitter, warm
- **Channels:** Kidney, Spleen, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Moves qi and alleviates pain:

Indications – for qi stagnation and cold accumulation with chest and abdominal distention and pain. *Wu Yao, Mu Xiang, Bing Lang*

Actions: Warms and regulates the middle jiao, redirects rebellious qi downward

Indications – for stomach qi reversal due to cold, leading to vomiting, belching, or hiccups due to cold. *Ding Xiang, Bai Dou Kou, Shi Ti*

Actions: Warms and aids the Kidneys in grasping the qi

Indications – for asthma and wheezing due to Kidney deficiency. *Fu Zhi, Rou Gui*

Main Actions:

- Moves qi and alleviates pain
- Warms and regulates the middle jiao and redirects rebellious qi downward
- Warms the Kidney and grasps qi

Dosage: 1-1.5 grams. It is taken in powder concurrently with a decoction, or made into pills.

Cautions: Use *Chen Xiang* with caution in the presence of yin-deficient fire, or organ prolapse due to a deficiency.

Review questions

- Direction of Chen Xiang
- Actions and indications of Chen Xiang
- Herbs for cold constrain and qi stagnation leading chest and abdominal fullness and pain.
- Herbs warm up the Kidney yang
- Herb grasps qi in kidney

Tán Xiāng 檀香

- *Lignum Santali Albi*
- **English:** sandalwood, santalum
- **Properties:** acrid, **warm**, aromatic
- **Channels:** Lung, Spleen, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Disperses cold and relieves pain

Indications – chest pain from cold and qi stagnation: *Bi Ba, Yan Hu Suo, Xi Xin*.

Actions: Regulates qi, harmonizes the middle jiao, and relieves pain

Indications – for abdominal pain and stomach cold pain with vomiting of clear fluids due to cold and qi stagnation: *Sha Ren, Bai Dou Kou, Wu Yao*

Main Actions:

- Regulates Qi, harmonizes the middle Jiao
- Disperses cold and relieves pain

Dosage: 1-3 grams

Review questions

- Actions and indications of Tan Xiang
- Herbs for cold and qi stagnation leading chest and abdominal fullness and pain.

Chuān Liàn Zǐ 川楝子

- *Fructus Meliae Toosendan*

- **English:** melia, Sichuan chinaberry fruit
- **Properties:** bitter, **cold**, slightly toxic
- **Channels:** Bladder, Liver, Small Intestine, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Moves qi and relieves pain:

Indications – for hypochondriac pain, hernial pain, and abdominal pain due to constrained Liver qi or LV-ST disharmony.

- *Chuan Lian Zi* has a bitter taste and has a cold thermal property. It regulates Liver qi and relieves stagnation to treat hypochondriac pain, and abdominal pain with heat signs of irritability, insomnia, red face and eyes, and short temper: *Yan Hu Suo* (Formula: *jin ling zi san*)
- Hernial disorders with lower abdominal distention and pain caused by cold: Wu Zhu Yu, Xiao Hui Xiang, Mu Xiang

Actions: Kills parasites and stops pain:

Indications- *Chuan Lian Zi* kills intestinal parasites and relieves pain. It is most effective for roundworms and hookworms.

Main Actions:

- Moves qi
- Relieves pain
- Kills parasite

Dosage: 3-10 grams. Bitter and cold, the unprocessed herb is slightly toxic.

- Dry-frying increases its warmth, minimizes toxicity, and reduces irritation to the spleen and Stomach.

Cautions:

- Use *Chuan Lian Zi* with caution in cases of deficiency and cold of the Spleen and Stomach.
- Large dosages of *Chuan Lian Zi* are not recommended as it is slightly toxic.

Review questions

- Properties and Channel entering of *Chuan Lian Zi*
- Actions and indications of *Chuan Lian Zi*
- Herbs for Liver qi constraint leading to a variety of pain.
- Herbs for killing parasites.

Over dosage

The entire melia plant is toxic, with the fruit being the most toxic part and the leaves the least. Eating 6-8 fresh *Chuan Lian Zi* Fruits can cause dizziness, vomiting, diarrhea,

respiratory difficulties, palpitations, tremors, spasms, and in severe cases, numbness and unconsciousness.

Adverse reactions to Chuan Lian Zi usually occur 4 to 6 hours after ingestion, but may begin as rapidly as 30 minutes.

Treatment of overdose

The early stage of overdose (4 to 5 hours) may be treated with emetic methods, followed by the intake of 4 to 5 egg whites. If over-dosage of the herb occurred 5 hours prior to treatment, the patient should be treated with a purgative method by dissolving 10 grams of Mang Xiao in warm water as a drink to induce diarrhea and minimize absorption of the toxins.

It can cause acute Liver damage

Xiè Bái 薤白

- *Bulbus Allii Macrostemonis*
- **English:** bakeri, bulb of Chinese chive, macrostem onion
- **Properties:** acrid, bitter, warm
- **Channels:** Large Intestine, Lung, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Opens yang qi and disperses stagnation due to cold phlegm:

Indications – for damp-cold painful obstruction of the chest due to cold, turbid phlegm congealing and stagnating in the chest, where it prevents the dissemination and flow of yang qi.

- Xiong Bi (painful obstruction of the chest) with profuse phlegm
- *Xie Bai with Gua Lou Shi (gua lou xie bai bai jiu tang)*
- Xiong Bi (painful obstruction of the chest) with stabbing pain from blood stagnation: *Dang Shen, Hong Hua, Chuan Xiong*

Actions: Moves qi and eliminates stagnation

Indications – for diarrhea or dysentery with rectal tenesmus from liver and stomach qi stagnation: *Chai Hu, Bai Shao, Zhi Shi*.

- If damp-heat: *Huang Bai, Qin Pi*

Main Actions:

- Opens Yang Qi, and disperses stagnation due to cold phlegm
- Moves qi and eliminates stagnation

Dosage 5-10 grams

Cautions

Not recommended in cases where there is qi deficiency but no stagnation, or for patients with poor appetite.

Review questions

- Actions and indications Xie Bai
- Warming Herbs in this section for Xiong Bi (painful obstruction in chest)

Da Fu Pi 大腹皮

- Pericarpium Arecae
- English Name: areca husk, areca peel, betel nut peel
- Alternate Chinese Names:
 - Bing Lang Pi 檳榔皮
 - Da Fu Mao 大腹毛,
 - Bing Lang Yi 檳榔衣
- Properties: acrid, slightly warm
- Channels Entered: Large Intestine, Small Intestine, Spleen, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Regulates qi, directs qi downward, and expands the Middle Jiao (Formula: xia qi kuan zhong)

Indications- sensations of oppression, distention and fullness in the abdomen and epigastrium, and feelings of incomplete evacuation after defecation.

Actions: Promotes diuresis and relieves edema

Indication- edema or leg qi

- Accumulation of dampness and qi stagnation: Da Fu Pi, Hou Po, Chen Pi
- Da Fu Pi helps to reduce the accumulation of water to treat edema and leg qi: Fu Ling Pi, Sheng Jiang Pi

Main Actions:

- Regulates qi, directs qi downward, and expands the Middle Jiao
- Promotes diuresis and relieves edema

Dosage: 5 – 10 grams in decoction.

Cautions and contraindications

- Use Da Fu Pi with caution during pregnancy, because of its teratogenic 致畸 and fetotoxic effects, as shown in mice.

Da Fu Pi 大腹皮 Review questions

- Other name of Da Fu Pi

- How does Da Fu Pi regulate qi (xia qi kuan zhong)?
- Review all the herbs for treating abdominal distension.
- Review the herbs for treating edema.

Mei Gui Hua 玫瑰花

- *Rosae rugosae Flos*
- **English:** rosebud, bud of Chinese rose
- **Properties:** sweet, slightly bitter, warm
- **Channels:** Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Regulates qi and relieves constraint

Indication- Liver-disharmony with such symptoms as a stifling sensation in the chest, pain and distention in the flanks and epigastrium, belching, and poor appetite.

Actions: Regulates qi, harmonizes the blood, and disperses stasis

Indication- Irregular menstruation, premenstrual breast tenderness, and menstrual pain due to blood stasis.

Main Actions:

- Smooths Liver and relieves constraint
- Harmonizes the blood and disperses blood stasis

Dosage: 3 – 6 grams in decoction.